

PLATFORM SPECIFIC MUST-HAVES

Every smartphone OS has something unique to offer. In this section, we show you how to best exploit each OS

There are a handful of mobile operating systems in the market, fighting it out amongst themselves to gather more market share. Android and iOS are leaders in this sphere. The next two in line are platforms that were kings in the pre-iPhone era, who now have no choice but to reinvent themselves in their bid to fight for the third spot. We're obviously referring to Microsoft and BlackBerry. Each platform brings with it unique capabilities that get people hooked to their smartphones. Android, with its open roots, lets developers take wider control of the OS, who give you apps that can change your phone inside-out; while iOS attracts many developers who create beautiful apps for it. Also, loyalists love their consistent design and ease of use. Windows Phone's tile interface, while offering a consistent look and feel, gives useful information to the owner by a mere glance at the home screen. But there's no one OS that does it all. Apps mentioned here will mostly not work for other OSes. So take your pick — here's a list of platform-specific must-haves that you must install.